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Yan Xi's older sister came to visit the set, and filming for the crew was temporarily halted.

The director was inwardly displeased but could only silently endure it without losing his temper. After all, everyone knew she was a young miss with background and backing.

Even though the director had great fame and talent, if he could avoid offending capital, he chose not to offend it.

At worst, they would wait half an hour—the entire crew could afford that much.

However, the director hadn't rested for long before he called for the second unit to come film Liang Shi's solo scenes.

He came personally to discuss it with Liang Shi because the solo scene she was filming was emotionally heavy—it was a big crying scene.

He didn't know if she could get into the right emotional state quickly.

Based on her performance during the previous audition, the director believed in Liang Shi.

But Liang Shi's performance just now had been barely satisfactory—one could only say she was slightly better than Yan Xi, not in the zone at all.

If this big crying scene was also messed up, the director might really go berserk today.

Yet Liang Shi agreed without hesitation. Looking over at Yan Xi's side, they seemed to still have things to discuss.

Yan Lin was saying something to her, and Yan Xi had her brows tightly furrowed, looking unhappy.

Meanwhile, Shen Hui stood calmly beside Yan Lin, hands stuffed in her coat pockets, aloof and cold.

Liang Shi had already taken out her phone but put it back. Xu Qingzhu had told her before to stop meddling in matters between Zhao Xuning and Shen Hui.

Liang Shi decided to comply. After all, last time had turned into a huge misunderstanding.

She still remembered the scene of being collectively teased by three people—a famous scene of social death.¹

Solo shots were easier to film than two-person shots. She sat there and went through the lines again.

There weren't actually many lines; what mattered most were the expressions and emotions. The essence of a crying scene wasn't in shedding tears, but in being sad without realizing it.

Tears would all accumulate in the eye sockets, constantly swirling but never falling.

Then at the emotional climax, they would fall like pearls.

This was what beautiful crying looked like.

Most actors' crying scenes weren't very pretty. For a director to achieve a beautiful scene was too difficult—it required great patience to train the actors.

Before filming began, the director went through the lines with Liang Shi once more and confirmed that the emotions and ideas they both wanted to convey were the same before sitting back down in front of the monitor.

The director didn't hold much hope for her either.

As long as she didn't mess it up, that would be enough.

But the moment "Action" was called, Liang Shi's face appeared on the monitor.

That exquisite face was suddenly magnified, yet it could withstand close-up shots without needing any retouching at all.

The most authentic things were the most captivating.

Liang Shi's first take was much better than before, exceeding the director's expectations. However, it was clearly visible that she still hadn't fully recovered her condition.

After the director called cut, he told her to calm herself down a bit and then do another take.

Liang Shi agreed.

She was working hard to enter the character's emotions. In this moment, she wasn't Liang Shi—she was only the character.

This character was experiencing a great storm in life, even more heartbreaking than when she herself had been cyberbullied into leaving the industry in real life.

Liang Shi closed her eyes briefly, asked a staff member for a bottle of water, gulped down a few mouthfuls before slowly exhaling, then wiped the water from her lips with a tissue.

To match the character's image, she was wearing true red lipstick, making her makeup much more glamorous.

Liang Shi murmured through her lines a few more times by herself, each time louder than the last.

She was absorbed in entering the character's emotions, while on the other side, Shen Hui was silently watching her.

When people are doing something they love or excel at, they shine.

Just like Liang Shi right now.

1. Social death (社死): A popular internet slang term referring to an extremely embarrassing moment in a social situation that makes one feel like dying from embarrassment. ↩